

Roamly Groups

Taking a group booking feature to market on a curated local experiences platform.

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26 September 2026 · Weekend cohort

Roamly *Groups*

Book one local experience for the whole group. Everyone pays their own way.

No fronting the cost. No chasing anyone for it.

Start a group booking →

12,000+

vetted local hosts

40

cities worldwide

3x

industry repeat rate

HOW IT WORKS

1

Share one link

The group joins from a text message. No account needed.

>

2

Everyone pays their own share

Their card is authorised the moment they join.

>

3

Nothing is charged until the group is in.

The host holds every seat until then.

SM

SARA'S GROUP BOOKING

Milan street food tour

Saturday 14 March, 6:00pm · 3 hours · €48 each

G

Giulia

Vetted local host · Milan · 218 tours

holding 6 seats

YOUR GROUP

LT

Luca T.

✓ in

AB

Anna B.

✓ in

MR

Marco R.

✓ in

EF

Elena F.

✓ in

DV

Dario V.

invited

5 of 6 in

Sara has paid €48

Seats held until Friday. Nobody charged yet.

Roamly Groups · Go-To-Market Final Project

GTM strategy

Acquire the participants, using the organiser as the vehicle.

A group booking is not just a bigger booking. It puts five to nine people who have never used Roamly through an experience, introduced by someone they trust. The organiser is already sold. The participants are the growth.

CHANNELS

- In-product prompts and lifecycle email to organisers already in the funnel
- The group itself. Participants arrive through a peer, so the join screen is the acquisition surface
- Champions from month two. Slowest lever, and the one that compounds
- **No paid acquisition at launch.** The demand is already in the funnel. Buying traffic would hide whether the motion works

Revised after Module 2. The competitive read says distribution, not product, is where this fails. Airbnb sits upstream of the decision and I ruled out the one lever that answers that. Occasion-led paid search is back on the table, because it is the one thing Airbnb does not serve.

INPUT	THE CALL
Goal	Acquire
Motion	PLG plus CLG. PLG expands the organiser, CLG acquires the participant
Segment	Friend groups on milestone trips, four to ten people, where the organiser already uses Roamly. Narrowed in Module 2: the organiser is the customer, the participants are the growth
Product gate	Lightweight join. Email or phone, no full account needed to say yes
Settlement decided later	The card is authorised the moment someone joins and captured at a cutoff. The host holds the seats until then. Nothing is charged until the group is in
Brand	Extend the curated-experiences brand into groups. Do not move the category

HOW I WOULD KNOW IT IS WORKING

Leading	Participants who complete the join
Success	Participants who book their own experience within 90 days
Warning	High join rate, low 90-day booking. Dormant accounts counted as growth

Competitive intelligence and the bet

PRIMARY COMPETITOR · AIRBNB EXPERIENCES

Why they win	Distribution. If the organiser is already in Airbnb booking a stay, Roamly never enters the consideration set
Why we win	They built split payments in 2017 and retired it in 2018. This is ground they left, not ground they hold
The gap	No participant identity in a group booking, so no acquisition loop. They reported 30% of group bookings brought new users and walked away anyway

THE REAL INCUMBENT

Not another booking platform. It is a WhatsApp group, a spreadsheet and Splitwise. Free, already installed, and currently winning on Roamly's own platform.

Structural finding: everyone with supply has no coordination, everyone with coordination has no inventory. Roamly is the only one positioned to hold both.

Left open here: why would anyone pay a coordination fee when Airbnb shows one all-in price? Answered in Module 5.

BELIEF

Roamly Groups wins when the money is settled before the booking confirms. The organiser's real cost is not the coordination effort, it is being personally exposed to their own friends for money they have already spent.

THE BET

Own the occasion, not the destination. Roamly becomes the place people go when they are organising something for other people. That is the one search Airbnb does not serve.

THE SACRIFICE

I give up destination-led discovery, and accept the operational mess Airbnb refused to carry: partial payment failures, refunds and held inventory. That is the reason the position is defensible.

Positioning

COMPONENT	
For	The organiser of a friend-group milestone trip, four to ten people, already a Roamly user
Who need	To book one experience for everyone without fronting the money and chasing friends to get it back
We offer	One booking where the reservation, the money and the guest list are the same thing
Because of	The organiser stops being the bank and gets to be on the trip instead of running it
Despite	Roamly is not where trips start. 40 cities against competitors' hundreds, no tools for the deciding phase, and we have never held a group's money before
Better than	Airbnb, where the booking confirms against one card and the platform never knows the group exists. And the WhatsApp stack, which settles the money after the booking, which is when it goes wrong

THE STATEMENT

Roamly Groups is one booking that holds the whole group for a food tour, cooking class or guided hike. Everyone joins and pays their share as they join, so the organiser never fronts thousands on a personal card or chases anyone for it.

ONE-LINER

Nobody has to be the bank.

The For line narrowed. Module 1 said friend groups. This says the organiser inside that group. Everyone pays, but only the organiser is choosing Roamly. Everyone else is saying yes to a friend.

Tested with two cold readers. Both identified the organiser and the value without prompting. Neither could say what Roamly actually sells, which is why the statement now names the experience types.

Messaging

THE SHIFT

From: one person paid for everyone, then spent weeks getting it back. **To:** everyone pays their own way, the way they already do for everything else.

PILLAR 1 · THE ORGANISER

Value	You get to be on the trip instead of running it. You never put thousands on your own card and never ask a friend for money twice
Capabilities	One booking holds the group. Everyone pays their share as they join. A visible roster. Host capacity held for the party. Vetted hosts
Evidence	38% of group travellers have not been fully repaid, and 43% of those lost over \$1,000. Airbnb-commissioned survey, around 2017, directional. 12,000 vetted hosts, 40 cities, 3x repeat rate

PILLAR 2 · THE PARTICIPANT

Value	Saying yes takes one tap, and you are square with everyone straight away
Capabilities	Join by link, email or phone only. Pay exactly your share. See the itinerary and who else is coming
Evidence	Same marketplace proof. No product proof yet, because nothing has launched

ACTIVATED ACROSS THREE SURFACES

- Homepage headline
- In-app notification
- Participant invite email
- Asset: landing-page hero, built from the headline

A gap I would close before launch. I left the host out of the pillars here as supply-side. Module 5 then made the host the only party who pays. They need a pillar of their own: a full party, paid before the booking confirms, no no-shows.

The evidence layer is the weak one and I have left it that way. Pre-launch there are no testimonials and no beta numbers. What exists proves the problem and proves the marketplace. Neither proves the product works. A blind reader confirmed it: they read the numbers as proof the company is big, not that group booking works.

Pricing and packaging

DECISION	THE CALL
Goal	Enter a new market. Volume in year one, not margin
Model	Per transaction, inside the commission we already charge hosts
Who pays	The host. Travellers see one price, the organiser pays nothing extra, everyone pays their own seat
Packaging	No tiers. One rate, one payer
Research	Conjoint with hosts who already take groups

This answers the question Module 2 left open. There is no coordination fee, so the single all-in price Airbnb has trained travellers to expect stays intact. Nothing new appears at checkout.

I looked at charging hosts 23 to 25% on group bookings. It is defensible, they only pay more if the group fills. But it is worth about 16 euros a group, hosts already discount 10 to 20% for groups, and I need them on side at launch. Revisit in a year.

WHY THE HOST

The participant gets convenience, and charging them kills the thing I am trying to do. The organiser gets rid of a headache, but they are the one choosing between us and a free WhatsApp group. The host is the only one who genuinely gains: a full party instead of single seats, paid before the booking is confirmed, and no no-shows.

WHAT WOULD CHANGE EVERYTHING

How many of those people would have booked anyway. I am assuming two of six would have come on their own and four are new. That is about 38 euros extra per group and payback at roughly 4,600 groups. If it is four of six, payback goes past 9,000 and I would have to charge hosts more from day one.

Build and run costs are my estimates, not real numbers. Engineering and Finance need to replace them.

Second open risk. Card authorisations expire in around a week, and travellers are booking further ahead. If the gap between joining and the experience is longer than that, authorise-at-join breaks and it becomes a deposit at join with the balance at the cutoff. One for Payments.

What I took from this

FRICTION

- The evidence layer. Pre-launch there is no proof the product works, and the honest answer looks weaker on a slide than an invented number would
- Nothing in the brief gives pricing, order value or group size, so every commercial number had to be built from comparables and labelled as an assumption
- Working with AI drafts, the language kept drifting away from how I actually write. Rewriting for plainness took as long as the thinking

THE AHA MOMENT

Airbnb built split payments in 2017, knew that 30% of group bookings brought them new users, and shut it down in 2018.

Up to that point I was arguing why the prize was worth having. That finding changed the question. The space is not empty because nobody noticed. It is empty because someone with more resources tried and left. So the strategy has to explain why Roamly can hold what they dropped, not just why it is valuable.

TAKEAWAYS

- Each module's answer becomes the next module's input. A vague segment in module one shows up as weak messaging in module four
- Cold reads find what you cannot see yourself. Two readers independently failed on the same thing, what the product actually sells
- Naming what you are giving up is what makes it a decision. Without the sacrifice it is just a preference
- Later modules should be allowed to overturn earlier ones. Three of my Module 1 calls changed once I had done the competitive and pricing work, and saying so is better than presenting a plan that pretends it arrived whole

Draft. Replace with your own before submitting.

THE BET

Own the occasion, not the destination.

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Valeria Quintini · Product School Go-To-Market Certification · September 2026